

3612. Process String with Special Operations I

Difficulty: Medium

Link: <https://leetcode.com/problems/process-string-with-special-operations-i/description/?envType=daily-question&envId=2026-06-16>

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Problem:

You are given a string `s` consisting of lowercase English letters and the special characters: `*`, `#`, and `%`.

Build a new string `result` by processing `s` according to the following rules from left to right:

- If the letter is a **lowercase** English letter append it to `result`.
- A `*` **removes** the last character from `result`, if it exists.
- A `#` **duplicates** the current `result` and **appends** it to itself.
- A `%` **reverses** the current `result`.

Return the final string `result` after processing all characters in `s`.

Example 1:

Input: `s = "a#b%*"`

Output: `"ba"`

Explanation:

i	s[i]	Operation	Current result
0	'a'	Append 'a'	"a"
1	'#'	Duplicate result	"aa"
2	'b'	Append 'b'	"aab"
3	'%'	Reverse result	"baa"
4	'*'	Remove the last character	"ba"

Thus, the final result is "ba" .

Example 2:

Input: s = "z*#"

Output: ""

Explanation:

i	s[i]	Operation	Current result
0	'z'	Append 'z'	"z"
1	'*'	Remove the last character	""
2	'#'	Duplicate the string	""

Thus, the final `result` is `""`.

Constraints:

- `1 <= s.length <= 20`
- `s` consists of only lowercase English letters and special characters `*`, `#`, and `%`.